Shutter

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GAME IDEA

A detective moonlights as a photo developer, piecing together murder mysteries one polaroid at a time all from within a claustrophobic 4x4 red room. Each episode traps you in the red-lit silence with only chemical fumes and crime scene snapshots for company, slowly unraveling a new case as the photos emerge from the dark.

GAME OBJECTIVE

MAIN OBJECTIVE

To make the player feel genuine unease and horror as they uncover the truth behind each murder, where graphic imagery and high-stakes mistakes ensure that solving the case never feels safe or rewarding just deeply unsettling.

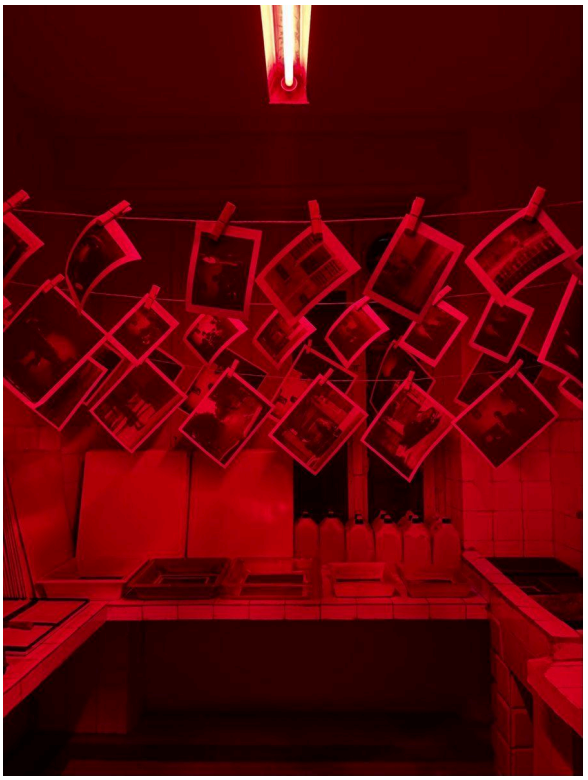
GAMEPLAY GOAL/S

A tense but satisfying experience where realistic darkroom mechanics like carefully developing photos and arranging them in order keep the player immersed, while the horror builds naturally through what the images reveal. When a case is finally solved, the relief should feel earned. Players should describe it to friends as 'stressful but I couldn't put it down.

PRESENTATION GOAL/S

To create a grounded, suffocating atmosphere through pure environmental storytelling a dimly lit red room that feels wrong without anything supernatural in it, just chemical trays, hanging photos, and the quiet that shouldn't be quiet. Text stays thin, plain, and clinical so it never pulls the player out of the moment. Sound does the heavy lifting: the slosh of developer fluid, the hum of a lone bulb, and the distant crackle of midnight insects making the silence feel alive and deeply uncomfortable.





GENRE

Single player, Psychological Horror, Puzzle

TARGET AUDIENCE

People who enjoy puzzle games but with horror elements

PLATFORM

PC/Console

SUMMARY

You play as Ray Walkers, a worn-down detective who moonlights as a photo developer to make ends meet. Every night, anonymous polaroids slip under the door of his tiny darkroom each set telling the story of a different murder. No names, no context, just raw unprocessed film and the truth waiting inside it.

The game is divided into self-contained episodes, each delivering a new murder mystery through a fresh batch of polaroids. Ray must develop each photo by hand using realistic darkroom mechanics submerging film in chemical trays, timing the development, and carefully hanging each print to dry. Once developed, the photos must be arranged in chronological order on a corkboard to reconstruct the sequence of events and crack the case.

The horror never announces itself. There are no monsters, no jumpscares just the red-lit silence of a 4x4 room, the chemical smell you can almost feel, and the slow creeping dread of watching a murder unfold image by image under your own hands. Some photos will be graphic. Some truths will be worse than not knowing. Every mistake in the development process a photo ruined, a sequence misread comes with consequences that make the case harder to crack.

When the final photo clicks into place and the case is solved, there is no celebration. Just the quiet of the room, the drip of chemical trays, and the distant crackle of insects outside until the next envelope slides under the door.

GAMEPLAY

MECHANICS

Photo Development (3 Stage Chemical Process)

Each polaroid must pass through three chemical trays in sequence:

1. Developer
2. Stop Bath
3. Fixer

Controls:

- **Right Stick (Up/Down)** — tilts the tray forward and backward to wash chemical evenly over the photo
- **Right Stick (Left/Right)** — causes the tray to jolt and shift in that direction
- **Left Stick** — re-centers and stabilizes the tray

Photo Alignment (Corkboard Chronology)

Once all photos are developed and hung to dry, the player moves to the corkboard.

Steps:

1. Process all photos first
2. Hover over each photo on the board
3. Select the photo
4. Place it into a numbered bracket
5. Arrange all photos in correct chronological order to solve the case

FEATURES

None right now

PRESENTATION

TEXT

Tone: Clinical, cold, and detached — like reading a coroner's report. Ray never emotes dramatically. His annotations and observations are brief, factual, and quietly exhausted. The text never tries to scare you, which makes it scarier.

Inspiration: The written tone of Disco Elysium's more sober moments, and the sparse labeling style of real forensic photography documentation

VISUAL

Style: Hyper-grounded and realistic in environment, with no stylization. The darkroom looks like a real darkroom nothing more, nothing less. The horror comes entirely from what is in the photographs, not from the room itself.

Interface: Minimal to near-invisible. No HUD, no icons, no menus during gameplay. Everything is diegetic.

AUDIO

Role: Audio carries the entire atmosphere. Without it the game loses its soul. It is the most critical presentation pillar.

Music: No score during active gameplay. Absolute silence broken only by ambient sound. A minimal, droning undertone may appear only during the corkboard sequence low frequency, barely noticeable, like tinnitus.